

Archana Vaidyanathan

Senior User Experience Researcher

avaidya2021@gmail.com • (510) 936-0522 • [LinkedIn](#) • [Portfolio](#)

SUMMARY

Senior UX Researcher with 10+ years of experience leading mixed-methods research and building research practices in complex, high-stakes environments - including regulated products handling sensitive user data. Proven track record of conducting foundational, segmentation, and evaluative research that directly influences product strategy and executive decisions. Skilled at translating nuanced behavioral insights into clear strategic direction, enabling cross-functional teams to develop a lasting understanding of the people they serve. Experienced building AI-native research workflows and scaling research through mentorship and democratization.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Established a dedicated UX research practice from scratch at [Hover](#) as the founding UX Researcher:** evaluated and selected tools (UserTesting, EnjoyHQ), built participant recruitment pipelines, initiated the insight repository, developed cross-functional taxonomies with customer success teams, and coached designers, PMs, and engineers to run high-quality studies independently.
- **Unblocked MVP launch of Meta's Risk Review platform through multiple rounds of iterative usability research** (35+ users, 4 profiles, A/B testing); drove a 5-point reduction in material risk failure rates and a 44% reduction in poor submission experiences - insights cited weekly in executive reviews.
- **Drove a 14.5% increase in purposeful engagement for audience-facing privacy settings/controls in Meta's family of apps** through multi-phase concept and usability research - demonstrating ability to connect generative insight to measurable behavioral outcomes.
- **De-risked the South Korea PIPA regulatory launch for 99.8M users by delivering rapid internal research** identifying critical UX and translation gaps under tight timelines - demonstrating ability to work in privacy-sensitive, regulated environments with real consequences for users.
- **Built an AI-powered usability evaluation bot on a proprietary usability evaluation framework;** enabled cross-functional product pods to run rigorous, consistent evaluations at speed without a researcher in every room.
- **Co-created usability and adoption metrics with data science partners,** establishing measurement baselines for privacy controls where none previously existed.

CORE SKILLS

Generative & Evaluative Research • Usability & Concept Testing (Moderated/Unmoderated) • Ethnographic & Foundational Research • Journey Mapping & Task Analysis • RITE methodology • Mixed Methods • Surveys & A/B Testing • Segmentation Research • Research in Regulated & Sensitive Data Environments • Research Strategy & Roadmaps • Research Operations & Infrastructure • Research Democratization & XFN Coaching • Participant Recruiting Pipelines • Insight Repository Management (EnjoyHQ, Airtable, Dovetail) • AI-Assisted Synthesis & Agents (NotebookLM, Outset.ai, Gemini, Claude, Manus) • Stakeholder Influence & Executive Communication

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior User Experience Researcher - Privacy, Risk & Compliance | [Meta Platforms](#) | Aug 2021 – July 2026

Embedded Staff-level researcher on foundational systems spanning privacy controls, risk review, and regulatory compliance. Led research for agentic risk review experiences with AI researchers at Meta.

Research Strategy & Executive Influence

- Led foundational and strategic research cited weekly in executive reviews, influencing product roadmap decisions at the highest levels of the organization.
- Led user journey mapping sessions at an AI-first Risk Review design sprint, directly shaping the MVP strategy adopted for the H2 roadmap.
- Influenced regulatory compliance across multiple markets (EU DSA, South Korea PIPA, NOYB) through rapid, high-stakes research under tight timelines, partnering with Legal and Policy.
- Led foundational discovery and literature review in emerging privacy-enhancing technologies (PETs), surfacing monetization opportunities across regulatory and competitive dimensions.

Multi-Complexity/Segmented Research in AI Risk and Regulatory Contexts

- Led end-to-end research across multiple iterative rounds with 35+ users spanning 4 distinct user profiles and 3+ design flows - developing nuanced understanding of how different user segments experience the same product differently, and making targeted recommendations that unified and personalized the experience.
- Provided early qualitative signal on how AI research teams navigate Risk Review escalation processes, surfacing counter-intuitive findings that shifted the team's pre-launch strategy.
- Drove a 14.5% increase in purposeful engagement for audience-facing privacy settings/controls in Meta's family of apps through multi-phase concept and usability research - demonstrating ability to connect generative insight to measurable behavioral outcomes.
- De-risked the South Korea PIPA regulatory launch for 99.8M users by delivering rapid internal research identifying critical UX and translation gaps.
- Co-developed usability and adoption metrics with data science partners, establishing measurement frameworks where none previously existed and connecting qualitative findings to business KPIs.

Practice Building & Research Enablement

- Built an AI-powered usability evaluation bot on a proprietary usability evaluation framework to enable cross-functional product pods to run rapid, consistent evaluations independently - scaling research without adding headcount.
- Designed and facilitated research workshops teaching UXR methods to non-researchers; drove research operations improvements adopted org-wide.
- Integrated AI tools (NotebookLM, Outset.ai, Gemini, Claude, Manus) into synthesis workflows, compressing analysis timelines from one week to days while maintaining methodological rigor.
- Mentored multiple UXRs through career coaching; managed a quant intern whose project became a P0 product initiative.

User Researcher (Founding) | [Hover Inc.](#) | *Aug 2019 – Jul 2021*

Sole UX Researcher responsible for building the entire research function from scratch for an AR-assisted property measurement platform.

- Established the full research practice: defined methodologies, evaluated and selected tools (UserTesting, EnjoyHQ), secured organizational buy-in, and built participant recruitment systems and study tracking infrastructure.
- Initiated the research insight repository using EnjoyHQ - built the foundation including participant recruitment systems, study tracking, and a catalogued insight library with cross-functional taxonomies developed in partnership with customer success teams.
- Coached designers, PMs, and engineers on research best practices, enabling them to conduct lightweight studies independently and with confidence.
- Conducted generative and evaluative research to understand homeowner pain points in onboarding and AR-assisted measurement accuracy, shaping core product decisions.

UX Researcher | [SAP Labs](#) | *Jul 2016 – Aug 2019*

Led research across enterprise-scale business software, developing deep understanding of complex workflows and stakeholder needs.

- Led research across enterprise-scale business software: usability evaluations, interviews, ethnographic studies, and experiments to influence long-term product planning.
- Drove the UXR enablement initiative by creating educational materials and coaching product teams on UX research methods and their business impact.

UX Researcher | [Google](#) | *Oct 2015 – Jun 2016*

- Led research for Google Photos informing long-term product strategy; contributed to a product that reached [200M monthly active users](#) and automatically applied 2 trillion labels in its first year (announced at Google I/O 2016).

EDUCATION

M.A. in Cognitive Studies in Education (Intelligent Tech), Teachers College, Columbia University | 2015

B.A. in Psychology (Honors), University of California, Irvine | 2010